Brightwave Technologies Employee Handbook

1. Working Hours and Remote Work

Brightwave Technologies employees work a standard 40-hour week. Core hours are 10:00 to 15:00 local time, during which all employees are expected to be reachable. Outside core hours, schedules are flexible as long as the weekly total is met.

Employees may work remotely up to three days per week. Fully remote arrangements require written approval from a director-level manager. Employees who work remotely receive a one-time home office stipend of $600, payable within 30 days of approval. The stipend can be claimed only once every three years.

2. Paid Time Off

Full-time employees accrue 20 days of paid vacation per year during their first four years. Starting in the fifth year of employment, the allowance rises to 25 days. Unused vacation days may be carried over, but the carryover is capped at 5 days and expires on March 31 of the following year.

Sick leave is separate from vacation: every employee receives 10 paid sick days per calendar year. A doctor's note is required only for absences longer than 3 consecutive days. Parental leave is 16 weeks at full pay for the primary caregiver and 6 weeks at full pay for the secondary caregiver.

3. Expenses and Travel

Business travel must be booked through the Brightwave travel portal at least 14 days in advance when possible. Economy class is required for flights shorter than 6 hours; premium economy is allowed for flights of 6 hours or longer. Hotel stays are reimbursed up to $180 per night in standard cities and $260 per night in Tier-1 cities (New York, San Francisco, London, Tokyo).

Meals while traveling are reimbursed up to $65 per day. Receipts are required for every expense above $25. Expense reports must be submitted within 30 days of the trip, and reimbursement is paid in the next payroll cycle. Alcohol is never reimbursable.

4. Learning and Development

Each employee has an annual learning budget of $1,500 for courses, books and conferences. Conference attendance beyond the budget requires VP approval. Employees who leave the company within 12 months of a reimbursed course of $500 or more must repay the cost on a pro-rated basis.

5. Security Policy

All company laptops use full-disk encryption and must be locked when unattended. Passwords must be at least 14 characters and are rotated every 180 days. Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for email, the code repository and the VPN. Security incidents must be reported to

security@brightwave.example within 2 hours of discovery.

Personal devices may access company email only through the managed mobile app. Storing customer data on personal devices or USB drives is strictly prohibited and may lead to disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

6. Performance Reviews and Promotions

Performance reviews take place twice a year, in June and December. Ratings use a five-point scale from 1 (needs improvement) to 5 (exceptional). A promotion requires a rating of 4 or higher in two consecutive review cycles, plus a written recommendation from the employee's manager. Salary adjustments from promotions take effect on the first day of the following quarter.